

Gupshup Cricket Icons

Cricket lovers, have your share of fun during the current season of cricket using "Cricket Icons" launched by Gupshup Messenger. <http://dgit.in/GupShuP>

**Yahoo! acquires Tumblr**

After the tons of rumors and guesses, Yahoo! finally acquired Tumblr for \$1.1 billion, promises "not to screw it up" <http://dgit.in/19Juwj0>

Market Mutability

Affordable quad-core smartphones made a splash this month with lot of local players announcing such phones as well, BlackBerry had some announcements, Nokia gave us some eye-candy with its newest Asha phone launch and much more...

Abhinav Lal

abhinav.lal@thinkdigit.com

The biggest India launch in recent times has been that of the Samsung Galaxy S4 at ₹41,500! However, a lot of other developments this past month have made waves in the mobile space. The biggest of these is the announcement and launch of affordable quad-core devices from major international manufacturers such as Samsung, Panasonic, and Acer, apart from a bevy of such devices from domestic manufacturers.

There were other revelations in the mobile space this past month, such as Nokia's new Asha OS and Lumia 925, BlackBerry's Q5 and BBM for Android/iOS, and Jolla's unveiling of the spanking new Sailfish OS and phone, which is as yet unnamed.

'Affordable' Quad-Core Smartphones

Panasonic launched its P51 dual-SIM Android smartphone in India in mid-May, based on Jelly Bean. Apart from dual-SIM (WCDMA-GSM), the biggest USPs of the Panasonic P51 is the bundled capacitive stylus and handwriting recognition support, its large 2,500 mAh battery, and its 5-inch IPS HD (1280x720 pixels) display. It will also ship with a smart magnetic flip cover. The P51 has been priced at ₹26,900.



Samsung Galaxy Grand Quattro

The Panasonic P51 runs on a 1.2 GHz quad-core processor (the MediaTek MT6589 chipset we've been seeing in the recent budget quad-core handsets), coupled with 1GB of RAM. It bears 4 GB of built-in storage, expandable up to 32GB via microSD card. Weighing in at 135 grams, with a thickness of 8.5 mm, the P51 features an 8MP autofocus camera with LED flash, and a front-facing 1.3MP camera.

Samsung also announced the launch of the Galaxy Grand Quattro in India. The Galaxy Grand Quattro is powered by 1.2GHz quad-core processor, 1GB of RAM and Android 4.1.2 (Jelly Bean) preloaded. The phone has a 4.6-inch display with a resolution of 480 x 800 pixels. There is a 5MP rear camera onboard as well. Sam-

sung says the price of the 8GB version in India is ₹17,290, and it is already retailing on Samsung's own online store for ₹16,900. Speaking of storage, the Quattro has a memory card slot as well. A lot of the additional features in the Quattro are the ones seen on the higher-end Galaxy range of smartphones, including Easy Mode, Smart Alert, and Motion UI gesture control.

Acer also entered the budget quad-core smartphone race with the launch of the Liquid E2 in Europe, and is expected to hit India soon, priced somewhere between ₹15,000 and ₹20,000. The Liquid E2 will run on the MediaTek MT6589 chipset, with the quad-core 1.2GHz CPU, and 1GB of RAM. It has 4GB built-in storage expandable up to 32GB via a microSD card. The rear of the Acer Liquid E2 has an 8MP AF rear camera with an LED flash and a BSI sensor. The front of the smartphone has a 2MP camera. The display is 4.5-inches with a qHD resolution. A dual-SIM variant will also be available.

As for the smaller, domestic manufacturers, we saw a lot of affordable quad-cores being launched in India, such as the Lava Iris 458q for ₹8,999, Gionee Elife E3 for ₹14,999, Micromax Canvas Doodle A111 at ₹12,999, Celkon A119Q Signature HD at ₹12,499, Xolo Q700 at ₹9,999, and Karbonn S2 Titanium at ₹10,790.

BlackBerry Announcements

In the beginning of May, the Canadian smartphone company started to roll out the first major BlackBerry 10 OS update, v10.1. While BlackBerry has not released a detailed changelog, we know from previous reports that the new BB10.1 update would bring improvements in PIN to PIN messaging, HDR stills functionality, an enhanced BlackBerry World store, new help demos and walkthroughs, APN editing, the ability to turn off alerts for particular apps, text highlight feature in green, and more.

BlackBerry Live 2013 had some interesting announcements, such as the BlackBerry Q5, a cheaper Q10 device, with a full physical keyboard and a 3.1-inch touchscreen display. The good part is that the Q5 is targeted at emerging markets and effectively India should be seeing



BlackBerry Q5